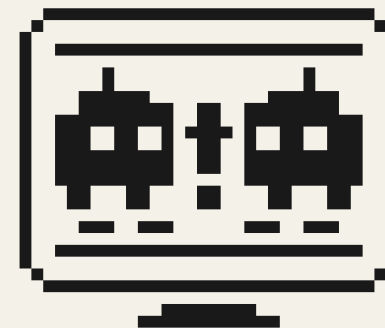


CAPTURE THE SYSTEM / FIELD GUIDE

YOUR BOT. THEIR PROBLEM.

Build a bot. Submit it. Compete for CTF points.
The player essentials, without the reverse-engineering
spoilers.



BOT VS BOT / 1 BIT

01 BUILD	>	02 SUBMIT	>	03 EVALUATE	>	04 SCORE
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JUMP TO A QUESTION

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- 04 CTF points
- 05 Troubleshooting

Open only what you need.
The executor is the puzzle.

01 Start here

What do I need to get started?

1. Download the supplied executor from the challenge materials.
2. Build and test a bot locally; prepare a `.bin` or `.hex` file.
3. Get your **Submission Token** from the Capture The System challenge card in the [CTF portal](#).
4. Open the challenge's leaderboard, sign in with that token, and upload your bot.

Is my Submission Token a flag?

No. It identifies your CTF account when you submit a bot. Use the token from the Capture The System challenge card, and keep it private. Do not share it in screenshots, source code, or chat.

Where are the instruction set and strategy guide?

—

The supplied executor is the technical specification. Reverse engineering it is part of the challenge.

This FAQ explains the competition, not how to solve it. Instruction encodings, execution internals, hidden evaluation parameters, vulnerabilities, and strategies are intentionally left out.

02 Submit a bot

What can I upload?

—

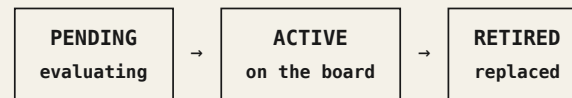
Use the leaderboard uploader for a binary `.bin` file or a hexadecimal `.hex` file. The server validates the program; changing a filename does not convert an invalid file into a valid bot.

Test locally with the supplied executor before uploading.

What happens after I submit?

—

A valid upload creates a new revision. Watch its status on the leaderboard; a successful upload does not mean its results are already published.



After evaluation completes, the pending revision becomes active and the previous active revision is retired. Until then, your previous active bot remains in use. Revision contents are immutable: improving the bot means submitting another revision.

Can I replace my bot whenever I want?

—

You can have only one pending revision at a time. Wait for its evaluation to finish before uploading another.

Submissions also follow the current cooldown, deadline, and any organizer pause. Follow the uploader's status and the server's error message rather than repeatedly resubmitting.

A replacement identical to your active bot is rejected as a duplicate. Upload a changed bot when submissions are available.

Can I submit through the API? —

Yes. On the leaderboard host, send POST /api/v1/submissions with Authorization: Bearer YOUR_SUBMISSION_TOKEN.

- Binary: raw file bytes with Content-Type: application/octet-stream.
- Hexadecimal: hex text with Content-Type: text/plain.

Send the body directly, not as JSON or a multipart file upload. The same validation and submission restrictions apply.

03 Read the results

Why didn't my results change immediately? —

Live evaluation is published in completed sweeps. A sweep becomes visible together, rather than exposing partially updated results while it runs.

A pending revision and an unchanged table do not, by themselves, mean that your upload failed. Check the revision status first.

What do wins, ties, losses, and games mean? —

They summarize your evaluated results. Games includes wins, ties, and losses; a draw does not count as a win for the CTF points formula.

The live table keeps the newest result for each team pair. It is not a lifetime total of every match you have ever played, so standings can change as bots and opponents change.

How is leaderboard rank decided? —

More wins comes first, then more ties, then fewer losses. If those are equal, the earlier active submission comes first, followed by team ID in ascending order.

This leaderboard order is also used to break equal win rates in the CTF points calculation.

Do the matches on the broadcast count? —

No. Broadcast matches are exhibitions. Watching a bot win or lose there does not change its leaderboard standings or CTF points.

Is the live leaderboard my final CTF score? —

No. The leaderboard displays evaluation results; CTF points are calculated from the scored board and published separately to the CTF platform.

Do not treat the live preview as a promise of final placement. Follow organizer announcements for the submission cutoff and final grading.

04 CTF points

How do I earn between 100 and 5000 points? —

Your points are based on your win rate, with a small deduction to order equal win rates. The scored players must have equal game totals.

```
win rate = wins / games
adjusted rate = win rate - tie deduction
points = 100 + 4900 × adjusted rate
```

For a player on the scored board, zero wins earns 100 points. A perfect record with no deduction earns 5000. With no games, the win rate is treated as zero.

The current leader is **not** automatically awarded 5000: scores are not scaled against the best bot.

Examples before any tie deduction

Wins / games	Win rate	Points
0 / 10	0%	100

Wins / games	Win rate	Points
5 / 10	50%	2550
10 / 10	100%	5000

What if two players have the same win rate?

—

Within each equal-win-rate group, players are ordered by leaderboard rank. Their tie positions start at 0, then 1, 2, and so on.

`deduction = min(win rate, tie position × 0.0004)`

The first player loses nothing. Each next position deducts another 1.96 points, stopping at the 100-point floor. For example, two players with a 50% win rate receive 2550.00 and 2548.04 before platform rounding.

Why are the platform points slightly different?

—

The CTF platform receives points / 5000, rounded half-up to four decimal places. On a 5000-point challenge, this gives half-point steps: 2548.04 becomes 2548.00.

Score updates are published separately from the live leaderboard. A delay in the platform display does not change the scoring formula.

05 Troubleshooting

My submission failed. What should I check?

—

- **Authentication:** use your Capture The System Submission Token, without extra spaces.
- **Invalid program or format:** check the uploaded file, and test it locally. For API uploads, check the content type too.
- **Evaluation pending:** wait for your current pending revision to finish.
- **Duplicate bot:** the replacement must differ from your active bot.
- **Cooldown:** wait for the stated retry time.
- **Paused or closed:** check the submission status and organizer announcements.

Keep the exact error message when asking for help, but remove your token.

What should I include when asking for help?

Share the time of the problem, the visible error, and the revision ID if you have one. Say whether it happened during upload, while waiting for results, or on the CTF platform.

Never include your Submission Token. Crop or redact screenshots before sharing them.
